

PHENOMENOLOGY (HUSSERL) — METHOD; THEORY OF ESSENCES; AVOIDANCE OF PSYCHOLOGISM

Paper 1: Section A, Item 9. One continuous rail: read every stage in order. The core spine runs 01–38; the single grey stage at the end is optional enrichment and repairs nothing.

CENTRAL QUESTION — stop asking whether the world exists; ask how anything comes to have meaning for consciousness at all.

THE ONE MOVE — the existence-question is neither answered nor denied. It is put out of play, so that the modes in which objects are given can be described without prejudice.

ANSWER LINE Husserl replaces the demand for a theory of consciousness with the demand that description of givenness come first.

OWNER SCOPE AND THE FENCE

7 owned parts of 112 in the 2018–2025 corpus. 2018 is the only empty year — and its Q4(a) still opens 'What is Epoché?'

OWNED HERE

- Natural attitude, general thesis, suspension, bracketing, residue
- Four operations and the three purposes they serve
- Intentionality, noesis/noema, hallucination, principle of principles
- Profiles, horizons, synthesis, lifeworld, graded evidence
- Hyle and morphé, retention, primal impression, protention
- Essence, free imaginative variation, Wesensschau, ontologies
- Constitutional a priori, four Prolegomena arguments, ideal objectivity
- Transcendental-ego, Descartes comparisons, Fifth Meditation

BOUNDED ORIENTATION

- Inner time-consciousness — optional methodological depth
- Categorical intuition: formal and regional ontology
- Life-world and the Crisis — one evaluative paragraph only
- Frege's 1894 review: the fallacious / Mohanty dispute
- Merleau-Ponty's 'Incomplete reduction'

NOT OWNED

- Being-in-the-world, Dasein, authenticity, Sartre on freedom — Topic 10
- Methodic doubt, the cogito's proof, God's proofs, dualism — Topic 02
- Categories and apperception — Topic 04
- Verification and the Vienna Circle — Topics 07 (a real)
- Phenomenology of religious experience, Otto, Scheler — Paper 8

PROVENANCE RAIL — THE DATES ARE EXAMINABLE

Much of the corpus is posthumous in whole or in part. Four cheap marks live in this rail.

1891

Philosophie der Arithmetik — number grounded in the acts of collecting and counting; Husserl's own psychological phase

1894

Frege's review, Zeitschrift für Philosophie und philosophische Kritik, Passphrase the charge never quote the 'arithmetic' sentence as his

1900-01

Logical Investigations, Vol. I = Prolegomena to Pure Logic, Vol. II = the six Investigations, the fifth on categorial intuition. Cite the volume.

1901

'Philosophy as a Rigorous Science', journal Logos — naturalism and historicism named as the enemies

1913

Ideas I — §§31–32 the epoché, §§5 hyle and morphé, §24 the principle of principles. Boyce Gibson 1931 and Kersten 1982 differ in wording, not in 5 numbers.

1893-1917 / 1928

The internal-time lectures, edited by Edith Stein and published by Heidegger in 1928. Never 'Husserl's 1928 book'.

1929 – 1931

1931's lectures, February 1929: Meditations cartésiennes in French first (Levinas and Peiffer, 1931); the German text posthumously in 1950. Cairns' translation 1960.

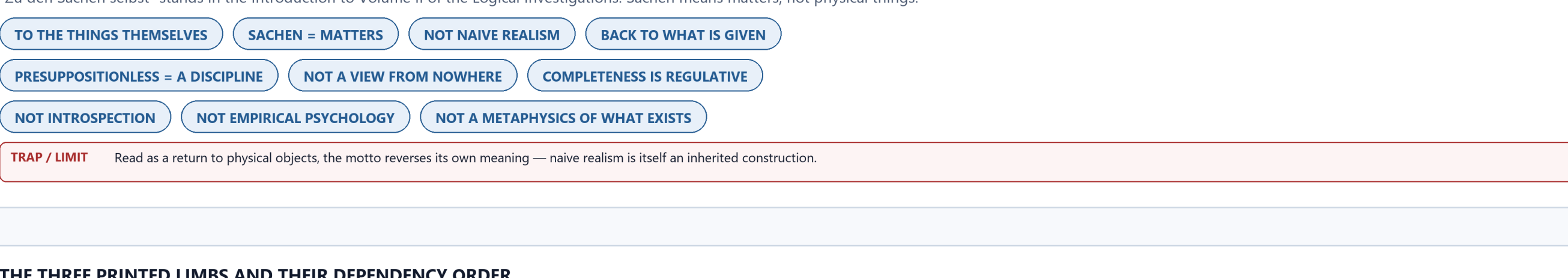
1936 – 1956

§§16 Parts I–II in Philosophy (Belgrade) Husserl dies in 1938; the complete text only in 1954 (Husserliana VI, ed. Bernal). Car's translation 1970.

TRAP / LIMIT The Crisis (1936) and 'Cartesian Meditations (1931, German)' are both wrong, and both are corrected in six words.

THE PROGRAMME — WHAT PHENOMENOLOGY IS FOR

The 1911 Logos essay names two enemies, both collapse into one self-refutation, and the remedy is a change in the order of inquiry.



THE MOTTO, AND WHAT 'PRESUPPOSITIONLESS' MEANS

'Zu den Sachen selbst' stands in the Introduction to Volume II of the Logical Investigations. Sachen means matters, not physical things.

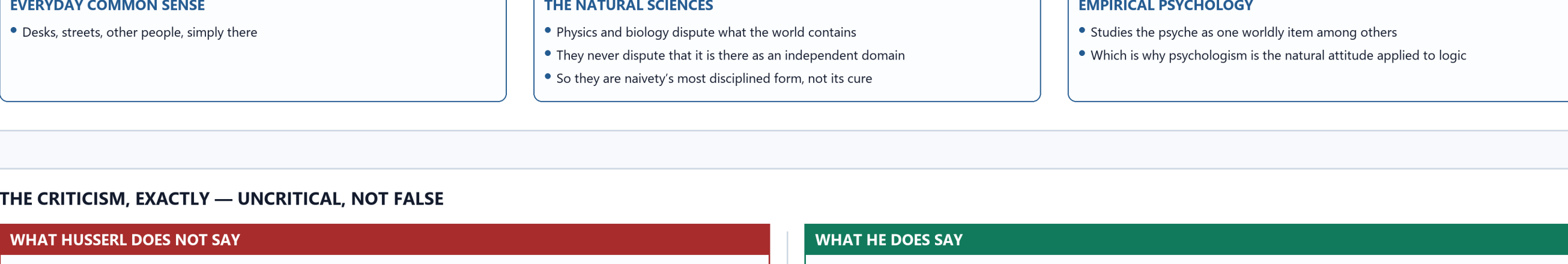
TO THE THINGS THEMSELVES **SACHEN – MATTERS** **NOT NAÏVE REALISM** **BACK TO WHAT IS GIVEN**

PRESUPPOSITIONLESS = A DISCIPLINE **NOT A VIEW FROM NOWHERE** **COMPLETENESS IS REGULATIVE**

NOT INSPECTION **NOT EMPIRICAL PSYCHOLOGY** **NOT A METAPHYSICS OF WHAT EXISTS**

TRAP / LIMIT Read as a return to physical objects, the motto reverses its own meaning — naïve realism is itself an inherited construction.

THE THREE PRINTED LIMBS AND THEIR DEPENDENCY ORDER



THE NATURAL ATTITUDE AND ITS GENERAL THESIS

NATURAL ATTITUDE The lived, pre-philosophical stance in which the world is pre-given: things are there, have determinate properties, persist unobserved, and are encountered by others.

GENERAL THESIS Its belief-character: the world exists, has always existed, and would exist without me. Lived, not asserted — it becomes visible only when a philosopher neutralises it.

NOT CONCLUDED TO The world is the horizon within which anything is concluded, which is why no particular correction ever dislodges the thesis.

WHAT THE ATTITUDE CONTAINS — AND WHY THAT MATTERS

EVERYDAY COMMON SENSE

- Desires, directs-on: people, empty there

THE NATURAL SCIENCES

- Physics and biology dispute what the world contains
- They never dispute that it is there as an independent domain
- So they are naïveté's most disciplined form, not its cure

EMPIRICAL PSYCHOLOGY

- Studies the psyche as one worldly item among others
- Which is why psychology is the natural attitude applied to logic

THE CRITICISM, EXACTLY — UNCRITICAL, NOT FALSE

WHAT HUSSERL DOES NOT SAY

- 'The natural attitude is false'
- 'The world does not exist'
- 'The sciences are mistaken'
- 'We should doubt the world'

WHAT HE DOES SAY

- The attitude is philosophically uncritical
- It blocks the question: how does the world come to have meaning for us?
- Any answer given inside it would presuppose the posing of the issue
- The sceptic is no better placed — he reverses the answer and keeps the question primary

ANSWER LINE Because the defect is a blocked question and not a false belief, the remedy must be a change of attitude and cannot be a counter-argument.

SUSPENSION (EPOCHÉ) — WHAT IS BRACKETED, WHAT SURVIVES

Ideas I §§31–32: the general thesis is 'put out of play'. Greek epoché = withholding of assent — the Sceptics' word with its purpose reversed.

BRACKETED

- The evidence pool of the world and of every object
- The naïve validity of the natural sciences
- My own psyche as a worldly thing

NOT BRACKETED

- The stream of experience with all its intentional contents
- The full content of what appears: colour, shape, distance, side, horizon
- The object's claim to be that kind of object

TRAP / LIMIT 'The epoché brackets the world' is close enough to repeat and wrong enough to lose the topic. The bracket falls on a validity-claim, never on a content.

THE RESIDUE — WIDER, NOT NARROWER

EXPERIENCE AS LIVED
The whole stream, retained intact under the bracket.

MINUS THE EXISTENCE-POSIT
One validity-claim withdrawn, and nothing else.

PLUS WHAT WAS NEVER RECORDED
Horizon and profile — features the natural attitude was too busy to notice.

RESIDUUM — the entire field of pure experience in its self-givenness

SUSPENSION AGAINST CARTESIAN DOUBT — THREE DIFFERENCES, NOT ONE

	OPERATION	AIM	RESULT
DESCARTES	Denies whatever can be doubted	The indubitable	A thinking substance whose world must be rebuilt through divine non-deception
HUSSERL	Withholds assent — neither affirms nor denies	The purely given	A field of constitution in which the world was never lost
ALSO NOT	Scepticism, which answers the question negatively and stays inside the attitude	Berkeley — transcendental idealism is not esse est percipi	A proof of idealism — that is a later argued result about constitution

THE FOUR OPERATIONS — DISTINCT FUNCTIONS, NOT RUNGS

1 SUSPENSION
Am I leaning on the existence-claim? Withholds the natural-attitude posit. Error: confusing it with doubt or denial.

2 EIDETIC REDUCTION
What cannot be beyond itself? Fact — essence by free imaginative variation. Error: fusing it with 2 — one brackets existence, the other extracts essence.

3 PHENOMENOLOGICAL REDUCTION
How is this given? Leads back — re-decure — to consciousness as the field of meaning. Error: treating it as a second bracketing.

4 TRANSCENDENTAL REDUCTION
For whom does some other? Discloses transcendental subjectivity as a field. Error: reading the residue as a res cogitans.

TRAP / LIMIT Eidetic analysis already operates in the Logical Investigations (1900–01), before the transcendental turn of Ideas I (1913). There is no fixed ladder.

THE THREE PURPOSES — THE 2023 ROUTE

'Significance' means why, not what. Name each purpose with the loss it prevents.

1 EVIDENCE UNDER A CHANGED ATTITUDE
The stream is apodictically unavoidable as experienced — but apodicticity is not exhaustive transparency, and particular self-descriptions stay corrigible. Without it there is no evidence-base at all.

2 NO SUBSTANCE-INFERENCE
Consciousness is analyzed as intentional life rather than established as a separate mental thing. This reformulates, and does not dissolve, the mind-body problem. Without it phenomenology = Cartesian dualism with new vocabulary.

3 THE EIDETIC AND TRANSCENDENTAL QUESTIONS BECOME ASKABLE
Only a field cleared of factual commitment can be varied for invariants. Without it phenomenology is a diary of episodes — that is, empirical psychology.

ANSWER LINE Naming the three purposes and what each prevents is the difference between a 9 and a 12 on a fifteen-mark part.

INTENTIONALITY — BRENTANO INHERITED, THEN TRANSFORMED

BRENTANO
Every mental phenomenon contains an object 'intentionally with itself' (intentionale Involvement). The container image imites the inner-picture error.

HUSSERL'S THESIS
Every act of consciousness is consciousness of something. Directedness is essential and irreducible, not a feature some states happen to have.

THE CORRELATION
Naïve, the manner of intending, with noema, the object precisely as intended. One structure described from two directions.

TRAP / LIMIT 'Intentional' does not mean 'deliberate'. From intendere, to aim at: perception, memory, fantasy and imagination are all intentional; none is an act of will.

NOESIS AND NOEMA

NOESIS — ACT SIDE
Perceiving, remembering, imagining, doubting, judging, loving, fearing
Different noeses can intend the same act
Analyzed internally into hyle and morphé (stage 21)

NOEMA — OBJECT SIDE
What is intended, precisely in the manner in which it acts intends it
Ideas I (1913) vocabulary — do not project it back onto 1900-01
In vertical perception the object intended is the worldly object, under a sense and a profile

ANSWER LINE They are not two entities that meet; neither is intelligible without the other — already the germ of the correlational a priori.

THE TWO MISREADINGS THE DOCTRINE MUST SURVIVE

THE PICTURE ERROR

- 'The noema is an inner image between me and the world'
- A veil of ideas returns, and with it the sceptical gap Husserl is dismantling
- 'One claim to write the noema is not an inner picture'

THE REFERENCE ERROR

- 'Intentionality means the object must exist'
- Then imagination and hallucination are not intentional — exactly backwards
- Directedness, not successful reference, is the criterion

WHAT REMAINS OPEN

- Ideal sense, object-as-meant, or structured appearance?
- Failed, Sokolowski, Drummond divide
- The dispute is optional: the denial of the inner picture is core

HALLUCINATION — THE 2019 ROUTE

PERCEPTUAL, SEEMING NOESIS
Lived in the manner of perceiving, not of imagining.

FULL NOEMATIC SENSE
This shape, this colour, at this place, with unseen sides co-intended.

MINUS FULFILMENT
The empty intentions are not honoured; the failure appears as disappointment.

A GENUINE INTENTIONAL ACT — not a defective intention but an unfulfilled one

TRAP / LIMIT 'Yes, because everything is intentional' states the conclusion and skips the explanation the part demands. Saying yes also does not make hallucination veridical.

THE PRINCIPLE OF PRINCIPLES — IDEAS I §24

THE PRINCIPLE
Every originary presentive intuition is a legitimating source of cognition, and what is originally offered in intuition is to be accepted as what it presents itself to be — but only within the limits in which it is there presented.

WHY THE FINAL CLAUSE IS DOCTRINE
It makes phenomenological evidence graded rather than total, so Husserl can demand intuition as the ground of knowledge without claiming infallibility.

CITATION DISCIPLINE
Cite the § number and name the translation: Boyce Gibson (1931) and Kersten (1982) differ in wording, while § numbers are edition-invariant.

PROFILES, HORIZONS AND THE SYNTHESIS OF IDENTIFICATION

PROFILES (ABSCHATTUNGEN)
A spatial thing shows itself only in aspects
Essential to spatial objecthood, not a defect of human vision

HORIZON
Internal: the open system of further profiles of this object
External: the meaningful surrounding world
Determinable indeterminacy, not vagueness

SYNTHESIS OF IDENTIFICATION
Temporal — it requires retention (stage 23)
Identity is neither one sensation nor a private image

ANSWER LINE The analysis that begins from appearance yields an identity that no appearance exhausts — which is the standing reply to the charge of subjectivism.

FULFILMENT, DISAPPOINTMENT AND GRADED EVIDENCE

EMPTY INTENTION
There's a tick to it — meant, not given.

FULFILMENT
The tick is seen and concedes the sense is confirmed in experience.

DISAPPOINTMENT
It was a façade. The sense is corrected, not merely replaced — correction is itself an intentional achievement.

EVIDENCE (EVIDENZ)
Dynamic and graded: adequate givenness of a transcendent object is an ideal limit, never a total possession in one act.

TRAP / LIMIT Evidence is not a private feeling of certainty. Treat it as one and the hyle-layer objection lands unopposed.

HYLE AND MORPHE — IDEAS I §85

Husserl's own chapter formula: 'sensuous hyle, intentional morphé'. This is an analysis of the noetic side itself, not a third term beside noesis and noema.

HYLE — MATTER
Non-intentional sensory content actually lived through
Not of anything; it does not point beyond itself — that is the whole point
Lived (erlebt), never observed, a dependent moment found only in reflection

MORPHE — FORM
The emerging apprehension (Auflassung, Bewertung)
It confers directedness — it animates the material
Only the whole intends the same colour-data found a house, a patch in a painting, or a stain

TRAP / LIMIT Calling hyle 'an object of perception' collapses Husserl into Locke and Russell in a single phrase.

WHAT THE HYLE / MORPHE ANALYSIS BUYS — AND COSTS

THE LOAD-BEARING PAYOFF

- Hyletic data are never the objects of perception
- So there is no veil of ideas and no inference from data to world
- This separates Husserl from Locke and Russell

THE REVOLT POINT

- Merleau-Ponty (1945): the body organises the field before any apprehension
- Sartre (1943): consciousness has no contents whatever
- Both belong to Topic 10 — one clause each, as critics

THE STANDING DIFFICULTY

- A non-intentional datum cannot be given as anything
- Yet §24 grounds cognition in originary givenness
- Later passive synthesis absorbs the hyle — a task concession

ANSWER LINE The distinction succeeds in its negative task and is unstable in its positive one.

THE LIVING PRESENT

Lectures of 1893–1917, edited by Edith Stein, published by Heidegger in 1928. On a model of successive now-points a melody could never be heard.

RETENTION
The just-past still held within the present — primary memory, the 'comet's tail' of the now.

PRIMAL IMPRESSION
Unimpression: the now-phase, the source-point of all constitution — not an instant in time.

PROTENTION
The empty anticipation of the phase about to come, fulfilled or disappointed.

THE PRESENT IS ALREADY STRETCHED — which is why a melody, and not a series of tones, is heard

RETENTION AGAINST RECOLLECTION — THE MOST EXAMINABLE LINE

RETENTION — PRIMARY MEMORY
Part of this perception
I do not remember the note just played — I still hear it as just-past
Running off phenomena: retained passes sink in clarity

RECOLLECTION — SECONDARY MEMORY
Wiedererinnerung: a presentation (Vergegenwärtigung)
Of what is no longer present, brought back from a distance
It presupposes the completed perception it would have to make possible

TRAP / LIMIT The regress is live: if the flow constitutes time, what constitutes the flow? The flow constitutes its own unity: read either as self-grounding or as stipulation.

ANSWER LINE Consequences: temporal identity is constituted in the flow; Hume is answered; habituality and sedimentation become intelligible; Heidegger transforms it into ecstatic temporality.

ESSENCES — WHAT THEY ARE AND WHAT THEY ARE NOT

AN ESSENCE IS

- The invariant whatever's without which the phenomenon would cease to be that kind
- Ideal not spatio-temporal, not causally efficient, not generated by mental acts
- Objective, intersubjectively accessible

AN ESSENCE IS NOT

- A Platonic form in a separate realm — no, chorismos, no two-world theory
- A psychological item whose validity is a datable event
- A synonym for 'ideal meaning' or 'noematic sense'
- An empirical generalisation over observed cases

ANSWER LINE If essences were produced by acts of thinking, the theory of essences would itself be psychologism — which is why Limb 2 needs Limb 3.

FREE IMAGINATIVE VARIATION — THE MARKED CONTENT OF LIMB 2

1 BEGIN FROM ONE FACTUAL INSTANCE
A perceived physical object, a melody, a judgement — a single instance suffices to launch the procedure.

2 VARY IT FREELY IN IMAGINATION
Colour, size, material, duration, context. The procedure is a priori and is conducted in imagination, not in observation.

3 ASK WHETHER IT SURVIVES OR COLLAPSES
A triangle survives changes of size, colour, material and orientation; remove a side and the phenomenon breaks.

4 THE UNVARIABLE IS THE ESSENCE
The invariant here is a closed three-sided plane figure. The angle-sum claim is framework-dependent and must not be offered as the invariant of every possible geometry.

ANSWER LINE It is not induction because it seeks a limit, not a frequency — and no number of further instances makes a limit more secure.

WESSENSCHAU, CATEGORIAL INTUITION AND THE CONSTRAINTS

INTUITION OF ESSENCES
Essences are seen, not inferred. Wesensschau claims intuitive fulfillment for structures rather than for sensory items.

THE ANCESTOR
Categorial intuition, Sixth Logical Investigation — it fulfills intentions directed at states of affairs and categorial formations. Closely related, not one unchanged doctrine.

THE OBJECTION
Ryle and Ayer: how can we know that different subjects intuit the same essence? The presupposition — that intellectual seeing is as legitimate as sense-perception — is strong.

THE CONSTRAINTS
Further variation, counter-variation and intersubjective repeatability. Evidence is graded fulfillment, not a private feeling of certainty.

TRAP / LIMIT Historic-dependence, exhibited by the angle-sum caution, keeps the worry alive: eidetic results are reusable within a specified region.

FORMAL AND REGIONAL ONTOLOGY — ORIENTATION DEPTH ONLY

FORMAL ONTOLOGY	REGIONAL / MATERIAL ONTOLOGY	THE AMBITION
Object, property, relation, state of affairs, whole and part Applies to every region; analogous to formal logic	Nature: extension, duration, causality Consciousness: intentionality, temporal flow Culture and the social: intersubjectivity, norms, and mathematics	Phenomenology as the foundational science It grounds regional ontologies by clarifying how their objects are constituted One sentence in a 15-mark answer; a clause in a 10-mark answer; never a section

THE CORRELATIONAL A PRIORI — THE 2024 ROUTE

One essence — 'perception of a spatial thing' — read in either direction. Continuity, not identity.

NOETIC SIDE — HOW THE ACT MUST PROCEED
Perspectival, through profiles
Unseen sides co-intended
Held together by a temporal synthesis of identification
Open to fulfillment or disappointment

NOEMATIC SIDE — WHAT THE OBJECT MUST BE
Three-dimensional
Given in profiles, never exhausted by one
Possessing an internal horizon of further profiles
Identical through the senses; never adequately given in one act

TRAP / LIMIT Not a merger, not a third entity, not production of being. And the reframing of realism / idealism does not settle it — the transcendental idealism is accused, though it is not Berkeley's.

ANSWER LINE State three-dimensionality and you have specified perspectival givenness; state perspectival givenness and you have specified a horizonized object. That mutual entailment is the continuity.

PSYCHOLOGISM — THE DOCTRINE, THE HOLDERS, THE REVERSAL

Logical laws as empirical generalisations about how human beings in fact think. Mill, Lipps, Sigwart — and early Husserl.

CLAIM 1
'Non-contradiction describes how we cannot think' — a psychological impossibility.

CLAIM 2
'Logical laws hold because of the constitution of the human mind' — they would differ for differently constituted beings.

CLAIM 3
'Truth is what we are compelled to believe' — truth reduces to a psychological fact.

1891
Husserl grounds number in the acts of collecting and counting — the phase his later self classifies as psychological.

1894
Frege's review: the slide from the objective content of thought to the subjective act turns arithmetic into a description of mental processes.

DISPUTED
Fallestad (1958) says the review was decisive; Mohanty, Husserl and Frege (1982) argues from the manuscript for independent development; out of Bolzano and Lotze.

1900-01
The Prolegomena to Pure Logic, Volume I, carry out the demolition.

ANSWER LINE Naming 1901 converts 'Husserl opposed psychologism' into 'Husserl reversed himself' — truer, more interesting, and worth a mark on its own.

THE FOUR PROLEGOMENA ARGUMENTS — ONE CONFUSION, FOUR DIRECTIONS

1 NECESSARY AGAINST MERELY PROBABLE
Psychological laws are inductive and at best highly probable; logical laws are necessary. The necessary cannot be derived from the probable.

2 IDEAL CONTENT AGAINST REAL ACT
2+2=4 is an ideal, atemporal meaning: judging it is a real, datable psychic event. This is the root confusion, and the other three are its consequences.

3 RELATIVISM SELF-REFUTES
Specie-relative truth (idiosyncrasy) is asserted as absolutely true. Sharp from: the psychologist's own reasoning would be only probable and would undermine its own support.

4 CONDITIONS AGAINST GROUNDS
That we must think in accordance with non-contradiction is a causal necessity of our psychology; it does not explain why the law holds. The genetic: false.

ANSWER LINE Argument (iii) is the strongest at 15 and 20 marks; argument (ii) is the one from which the others can be derived.

THE POSITIVE RESULT — IDEAL OBJECTIVITY

REAL ACTS, IDEAL CONTENTS
Logical and mathematical truths have validity that is not identical with any datable psychological act. Phenomenology studies consciousness as the site where ideal meanings are grasped, without reducing the meanings to the acts that grasp them.

IT DEBATS TWO POSITIONS AT ONCE
Psychologism, which denied the ideal; and a naïve Platonism, which denied that the ideal is accessible to consciousness.

BOUNDARY CORRECTION
Anti-psychologism is not anti-mentalism. Husserl studies intentional acts throughout; he refuses only to make logical validity depend on empirical mental laws. Avoid 'subsidit' if it suggests a separately located realm.

THE TRANSCENDENTAL TURN WORRY AND THE THREE-PART REPLY — THE 2020 / 2022 ROUTE

After Ideas (1913) all meaning-constitution is located in the transcendental ego. Has psychologism returned at a higher level?

1 NOT THE EMPIRICAL PSYCHE
The psyche is a mundane object within the world and is bracketed with it; the transcendental ego is the condition under which world and psyche have meaning at all. The objection trades on treating 'subject' unvocally.

2 CONSTITUTION IS NOT FABRICATION
To say the sense of 2+2=4 is constituted is to say it is disclosed there, not invented. Subjectivity is the medium of access, not the source of validity.

3 OBJECTIVITY VIA TRANSCENDENTAL INTERSUBJECTIVITY
Not the preferences of one empirical subject. This limb transfers the burden to the Fifth Cartesian Meditation, and Schutz's clarity objection is a challenge to exactly that security.

ANSWER LINE Psychologism proper is escaped; transcendental idealism is not — a different and weaker charge. The reply is coherent but not decisive.

THE TRANSCENDENTAL EGO AGAINST DESCARTES — THE 2025 ROUTE

State the agreement first, or the answer reads as two portraits rather than one comparison.

ANIS	DESCARTES	HUSSERL
STARTING POINT	Methodic doubt — no cogito; the indubitable self-governed of the thinking act	Suspension — the same indubitable self-governed, sought as the purely given
THE EGO	A thinking substance, no cogitans	A field of sense-constitution — intentional, temporal, habitual, ultimately intersubjective; not Kant's formal 'I think' without qualification
WORLD-ACCESS	World knowledge rebuilt through divine non-deception	The world is never denied; its positing is bracketed and its modes of givenness described. No God-bridge, because no claim was opened
THE COST	—	Transcendental solipsism: if all sense is constituted for my ego, other egos become problematic